



"When it begins to get dark, instead of cooking dinner or making love, **we will assemble ...**"

BETTY FRIEDAN, FEMINIST WRITER AND ACTIVIST, CALLS FOR A NATIONWIDE WOMEN'S STRIKE, MARCH 20, 1970

EQUALITY NOW

In 1970, Betty Friedan ended her term as president of the National Organization for Women (NOW) with a speech calling women to action. Friedan's 1963 book *The Feminine Mystique*, which rejected the idealized image of the American housewife, had led many women to join the feminist cause, and Friedan hoped that a march would show the scope and seriousness of feminism's growing second wave. On August 26, 1970, around 50,000 women answered Friedan's call in New York City, where the Women's Strike for Equality blocked off Fifth Avenue as women marched with signs demanding equal opportunities in the workplace, abortion rights, and an end to the war in Vietnam (left).